New Details About a Batman Movie That Was Never Made

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Ben Affleck was once going to star in a movie called "The Batman," but it was never made. Now actor Joe Manganiello has shared new details in his book, "Bloodlines."

Manganiello was going to play the **villain**, Deathstroke. In the story, Deathstroke wanted **revenge** on Bruce Wayne. Batgirl, also called Barbara Gordon, was going to be in the movie, too.

Manganiello says the **villain** would have killed Police **Commissioner** Jim Gordon, Barbara's father and one of Batman's most loyal **allies**. That helps explain why Batgirl would have joined the story.

He also described a big action scene. Deathstroke would have almost beaten Batman and Batgirl, but the two heroes escaped on a train.

Because the movie was never made, no one knows for sure how it would have turned out. The story might have been **rewritten** if it had moved forward.

A similar story is happening now in the comic series "Absolute Batman," where Barbara Gordon becomes a hero called "the Bat."

Word Treasure

villain -- The bad guy in a story.
revenge -- Hurting someone back because they hurt you.
Commissioner -- The leader of a city's police.
allies -- Friends who help and support each other.
rewritten -- Written again in a new or changed way.

Background you need

Batman is a superhero from comic books who protects Gotham City.

Jim Gordon is the city's police commissioner and Batman's friend, and his daughter Barbara is the hero Batgirl.

Sometimes movies are planned but never made, and people who worked on them later share what they would have been about.

Break it down

WHO: Actor Joe Manganiello, who was going to play the villain in Ben Affleck's Batman movie
WHAT: He shared new details about the Batman movie that was never made
WHERE: In his new book, "Bloodlines"
WHY: Fans have long wondered what the unmade movie would have been like

Why it matters

It shows that stories can change a lot before they are finished, just like your own stories when you rewrite them.

Test what you remember

1. What is the name of Joe Manganiello's book?

- (A) The Bat
- (B) Bloodlines
- (C) Gotham
- (D) Justice

2. Which character was Manganiello going to play?

- (A) Deathstroke
- (B) Batman
- (C) Superman
- (D) Robin

3. Who is Barbara Gordon?

- (A) A villain
- (B) A reporter
- (C) Batman's teacher
- (D) Batgirl, Jim Gordon's daughter

4. How did Batman and Batgirl escape in the action scene?

- (A) On a rocket
- (B) In a submarine
- (C) On a horse
- (D) On a train

5. Why does no one know for sure how the movie would have turned out?

- (A) It was too long
- (B) It was lost in a fire
- (C) It was only shown in one city
- (D) It was never made

6. In the comic series "Absolute Batman," what does Barbara Gordon become?

- (A) A hero called the Bat
- (B) A police officer
- (C) A villain
- (D) A teacher

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: D 4: D 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Joe Manganiello: Says the villain would have killed Jim Gordon in the movie.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):